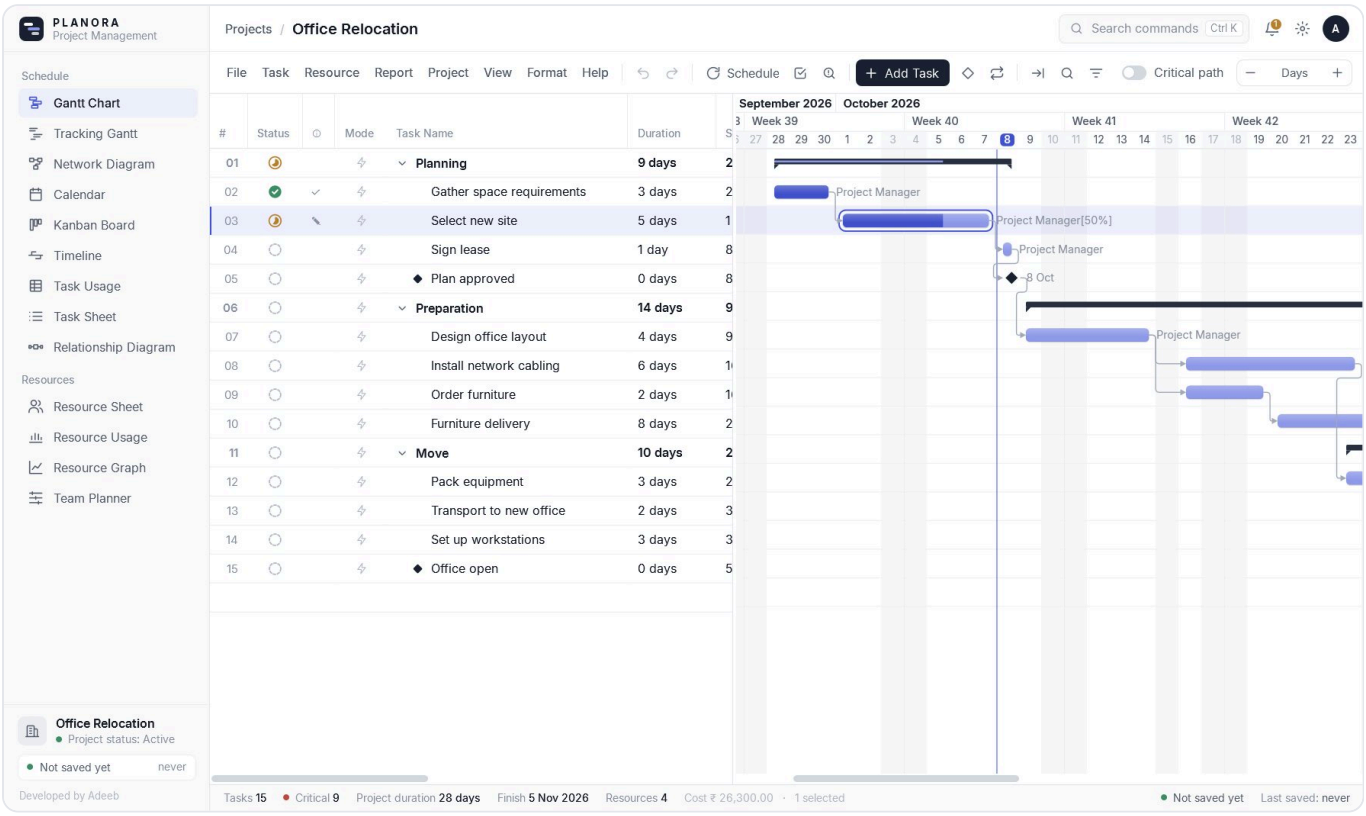
Introduction to Planora

Project scheduling and control software for Windows

Planora is a free Windows program for planning and controlling projects. It does the same job as Microsoft Project: you list the work, link the tasks, assign people and costs, and Planora calculates the dates, the critical path and the budget.



The main window: views on the left, commands at the top, task table and Gantt chart in the middle, status bar at the bottom.

Who it is for

Project managers, planning engineers, architects, contractors and students who need professional scheduling on a Windows PC without a paid licence.

What it does

Area	Features
Planning	Tasks, phases (summary tasks), milestones, durations, four link types with lag and lead, constraints, deadlines, recurring and split tasks
Scheduling	Critical Path Method (CPM): earliest and latest dates, total and free slack, critical path; working calendars with holidays
Resources and costs	People, equipment, materials and fixed costs; rates; overload detection; automatic resource leveling; budgets
Tracking	11 baselines, % complete, actual dates, Tracking Gantt, progress lines, earned value
Views	Gantt Chart, Tracking Gantt, Network Diagram, Calendar, Kanban Board, Timeline, Task and Resource Usage, Resource Graph, Team Planner and more (13 views)
Reports and output	16 built-in reports, a report designer, printing, PDF and image export

Files	Opens Microsoft Project .mpp files; opens and saves Microsoft Project XML, Excel, CSV, Primavera P6 and MPX
Ease of use	Command search (Ctrl+K), undo/redo of every change, autosave and recovery

How Planora is built

Part	What it is
Language	C# for the logic, XAML for the screens, on Microsoft .NET 8 (WPF)
Engine (the “brain”)	About 12,400 lines: scheduling, calendars, resources, costs, reports and file formats. It has no screens, so it can be tested on its own.
App (the screens)	About 18,000 lines: windows, menus, Gantt chart, dialogs and views. It shows the engine's results and sends your clicks back to it.
Tests	305 automatic tests; dates checked against three real Microsoft Project files (188 of 188 tasks identical)
Installer	One Setup file (118 MB) that includes everything; no administrator rights and no internet needed

How it works, in four steps

1. **Enter the work.** Type the tasks, their durations and how they depend on each other.
2. **Planora calculates.** The engine runs the Critical Path Method to find every task's dates and the tasks that decide the finish date.
3. **Add people and money.** Assign resources with rates; Planora adds up work and cost and warns about overloaded people.
4. **Track and report.** Save a baseline, record progress, compare plan against actual, and print or export reports.

System requirements

Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit), about 300 MB of disk space. Nothing else to install; works offline.

In one sentence: Planora gives you Microsoft Project-style scheduling, critical path and cost control on any Windows PC, free of charge.